

COMPANY ROLE SOPs

1. Team Leader SOP

Role Objective

Lead the crew in the field, confirm scope with the customer, run the job safely and efficiently, protect the property, manage the trailer correctly, and make sure the crew leaves the property clean with no equipment left behind.

Core Responsibilities

The Team Leader is responsible for:

- Driving the truck and trailer safely
- Confirming scope with the customer on arrival
- Walking the property before work starts
- Leading the crew on-site
- Making sure batteries are charging immediately
- Managing job flow, safety, trailer loading, and cleanup
- Protecting the property
- Communicating professionally with the customer
- Making sure no tools, batteries, or chargers are left behind
- Making sure the trailer tarp is secured before leaving

Main Priorities

1. Safety
2. Protect the property
3. Confirm scope with the customer
4. Keep the crew moving efficiently
5. Manage trailer flow and volume
6. Finish cleanup strong

7. Leave with nothing forgotten

On Arrival

The first thing the Team Leader does is talk to the customer.

He must:

- Greet the customer immediately
- Confirm exactly what trees are being done
- Ask how the customer wants the palms trimmed
- Walk the property if needed
- Make sure there is no confusion on shape, fullness, skirt, or final look
- Identify hazards, drop zones, vehicles, fences, pool screens, rooflines, and anything that needs protection

If the customer is not outside, the Team Leader still walks the property and confirms the scope before starting.

Before Cutting Starts

The Team Leader makes sure:

- Batteries are put on chargers immediately
- Saws, poles, ladders, ropes, and cleanup tools are ready
- The trailer is positioned correctly
- The crew understands the plan
- Everyone knows which trees are being started first

Charging batteries should happen immediately on arrival. Do not wait.

During the Job

The Team Leader is responsible for:

- Keeping the crew moving
- Watching job quality
- Protecting the customer's property
- Making sure ladders are held when needed

- Making sure nobody is working under falling material
- Watching for limbs falling in the air
- Keeping communication clear between climber and ground crew
- Adjusting the plan if the trailer starts filling too fast or if the job gets tight

If there is ever a choice between moving faster and protecting the property, protecting the property comes first.

Trailer Management

Trailer management is a major part of production, not an afterthought.

The Team Leader must watch the trailer all day and make sure it gets walked down as needed.

The trailer usually needs to be walked down every 2–3 trees, depending on how bushy they are.

You can often tell by the look of the load.

When stepping in the trailer:

- Walk the edges of the trailer
- Stomp the edges hard
- Focus on packing the sides down first

This keeps the load lower, tighter, and more efficient.

If the trailer gets full later in the day, one guy may need to stay in the trailer receiving limbs while the other guys throw or pass material up. The guy in the trailer must keep walking the load down the whole time.

Limb Stacking in the Trailer

Palm limbs must be loaded with structure, not randomly.

General trailer-loading rule:

- Middle of trailer = limbs laid vertically
- Front and back of trailer = limbs laid horizontally

This helps the load stack tighter and shove down better.

End of Job

Before leaving, the Team Leader must make sure:

- The jobsite is cleaned up properly
- All batteries and chargers are accounted for

- No tools are left behind
- The trailer is loaded correctly
- The trailer tarp is on properly and tight
- Nothing can fly out while driving
- The customer is spoken to if needed before leaving

The last equipment check before leaving always includes:

- Chargers
- Batteries
- Saws
- Poles
- Rakes
- Blowers
- Tarps
- Loose hand tools

Performance Standard

The Team Leader should be able to run a clean, safe, efficient job without the owner having to babysit every move.

Non-Negotiables

- No starting without confirming scope
- No sloppy trailer loading
- No forgotten chargers or batteries
- No leaving without the tarp secured correctly
- No avoidable property damage
- No crew standing around while the trailer or job is backing up

Field Rule for Everyone

Safety first.

Protect the property second.

Then keep production moving.

Then finish cleanup strong.

And remember: the trailer is a major part of production, not an afterthought.